Chapter 4

Conversation Skills I & II, Presentation Skills, Leader Skills and Oral Presentation I & II

Learning objectives

- Recognize the workplace/ desk/ front office/ telephone conversation.
- Prepare how to answer and conduct an interview.
- Identify types of conferences and meetings in academic and professional settings.
- Apply effective delivery techniques (voice, timing, audience engagement).
- Demonstrate professional etiquette and manners in formal speaking events.
- Cultivate spontaneous expression, collaborative skills, constructive feedback integration, and confident public speaking.
- Comprehend leader skills in Communication.

1. Conversation Skills I (Workplace /Desk /Front Office /Telephone conversation)

Introduction to Workplace Conversations

- Workplace conversations include front office interactions, desk communication, and telephone calls.
- Professional tone and courtesy are essential in business contexts.
- Verbal + Non-verbal cues significantly influence effectiveness.

Front Office and Desk Conversations

- *Front Office (FO)*: Greeting visitors, clarifying needs, giving directions.
- *Desk Conversations*: Short, polite, focused exchanges (e.g., updates, clarifications).
- *Key phrases*
  - ❖ How may I help you?
  - ❖ Could you please clarify?
  - ❖ Etc.

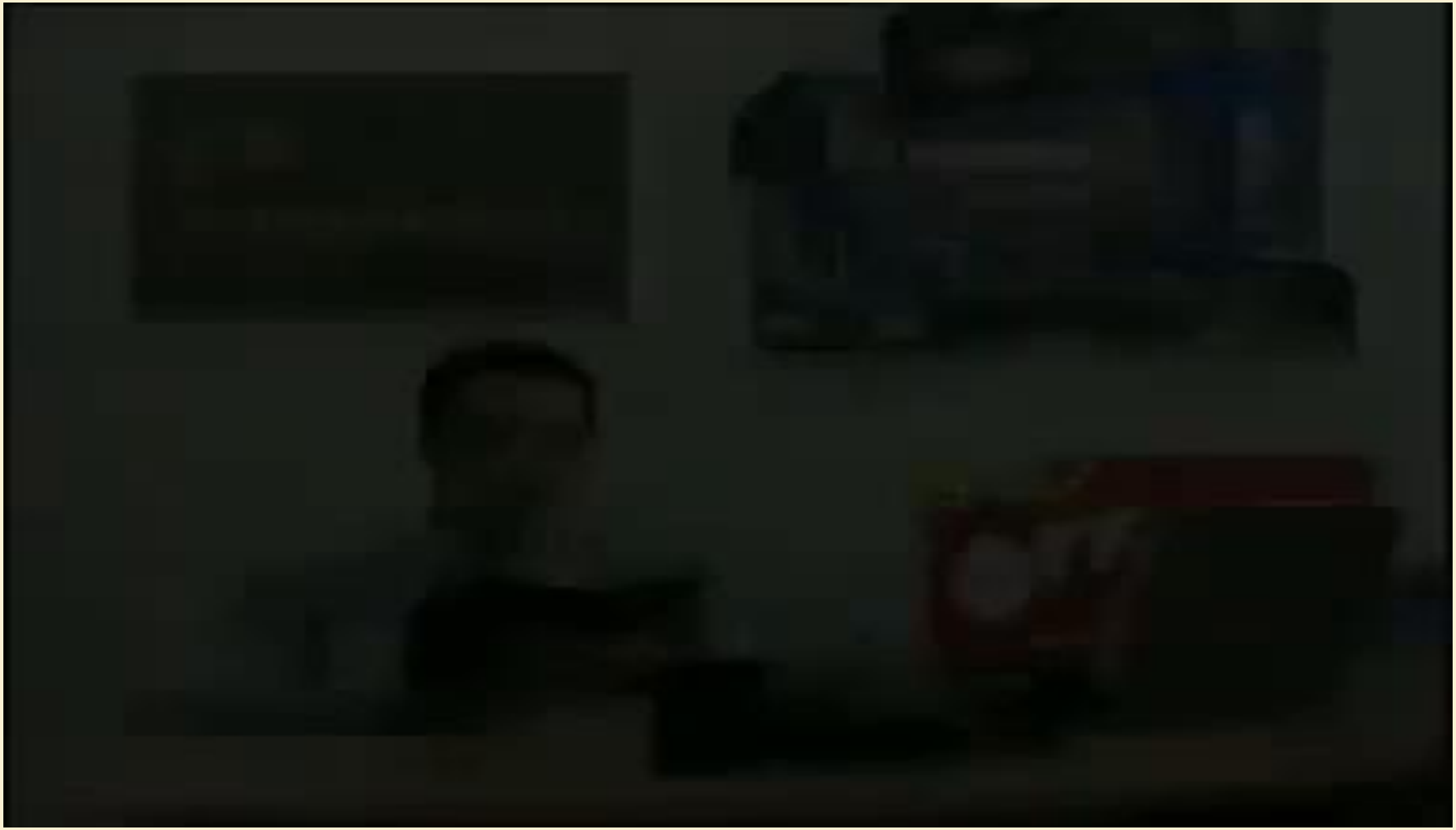
Example of Front Office Interactions

Source: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wyqfYJX23lg&t=28s

Telephone Conversations

- *Challenges:* absence of body language, reliance on voice clarity.
- *Strategies*: Speak clearly, pause for confirmation, and summaries before ending.
- *Example:*
  - ❖ Opening: *"Good morning, this is [Name] from [Company]."*
  - ❖ Etc.
  - ❖ Closing: *"Thank you for your time. I will send a follow-up email."*

Example of Telephone Conversations – Asking Information On The Phone



Source: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oEThDLRNtM4

Professional Email vs Casual Messaging

Aspect	Professional Email	Casual Messaging
Tone	Formal, polite	Informal, direct
Structure	Greeting, body, closing	Short, fragmented
Grammar & Punctuation	Correct and complete sentences	Often abbreviated

Listening Skills & Questioning Techniques

- *Active Listening*: Maintain eye contact, avoid interruptions, and paraphrase.
- *Questioning Techniques*
  - ❖ Closed questions (yes/no) for confirmation.
  - ❖ Open-ended questions to encourage explanation.
  - ❖ Probing questions to clarify details.
  - ❖ Etc.

Practice 1

- ***Role-Plays***

  - ❖ Pair practice: One student acts as a customer, the other as Front Office staff.
  - ❖ Telephone call simulation using audio prompts.

Your tasks:

❖5 - 10 members per group.
❖Discuss for 15 minutes.
❖Choose 2 members and assign roles to each member; Conduct your practice for 10 minutes on the stage.
❖The classmates vote on clarity, logic, and delivery.

In conclusion

- Introduction to Workplace Conversations.
- Front Office and Desk Conversations.
- Telephone Conversations.
- Professional Email vs Casual Messaging.
- Listening Skills & Questioning Techniques.

2. Conversation Skills II (Mock Interview)

Introduction to Interviews

- Interviews test both competence and communication skills.
- Preparation is key.
  - ❖ Content.
  - ❖ Delivery.
  - ❖ Confidence.

Example of Job Interview – Two Candidates

Source: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ln_3AVoBRLk

STAR Method for Interview Preparation

- ***Situation*** – Describe context.
- ***Task*** – Explain responsibilities.
- ***Action*** – Highlight steps you took.
- ***Result*** – Show outcome with evidence.
- ***Example***:
  - *In my last project (A), I was assigned to lead a team (B). I introduced weekly progress meetings (C), which reduced errors by 25% (D).*

Handling Difficult Questions

- ***Types of tough questions***
  - ❖ Gaps in employment.
  - ❖ Conflict situations.
  - ❖ Salary expectations.
- ***Strategies***
  - ❖ Stay calm; answer concisely.
  - ❖ Redirect to strengths.
  - ❖ Use positive framing.

Example of Skills Description

Source: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ln_3AVoBRLk

Description of Your Levels/Skills

- ***Your Education***
  - ❖ I hold a bachelor's/ master's degree in…from…
  - ❖ I have a bachelor's/ master's degree in…
  - ❖ I graduated from…with a bachelor's/ master's degree in…
  - ❖ Etc.

Description of Your Levels/Skills (Cont.)

- ***Other Hobbies/ Skills***
  - ❖ I am qualified in…
  - ❖ I have a particular interest in…
  - ❖ I have an IELTS certificate, my score is…
  - ❖ I think the valuable skill I have is…
  - ❖ My strengths are…
  - ❖ I have a flair for / I am good at…
  - ❖ Etc.

Example of Mock Interview

Source: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ln_3AVoBRLk

Example of Mock Interview (Cont.)

- ***Notes***
  - ***Internship*** is usually a period when a university student works for a company and does a job related to their degree to gain experience.
  - ***From the ground up*** = complete, all aspects.
  - ***To bring sth to the table*** = to contribute sth of value.
  - ***Proactive*** = taking steps without major guidance or supervision.
  - ***B2C (business to consumer)*** = a company selling items to individual customers.
  - ***To implement*** = to put action.

Practice 2

Mock Interview

- **Task 1:** One interviewer, one candidate, one observer.
- ***Interview Questions***
  - ❖ "Tell me about a challenge you faced and how you overcame it."; "Why should we hire you?"; Etc.
- After the interview, the observer must objectively evaluate and document both strengths and areas for improvement during the interview.

Your tasks:

❖5 - 10 members per group.
❖Discuss for 15 minutes.
❖Choose 3 members and assign roles to each member; Conduct your practice for 10 minutes on the stage.
❖The classmates vote on clarity, logic, and delivery.

In conclusion

- Introduction to Interviews.
- STAR Method for Interview Preparation.
- Handling Difficult Questions.

3. Presentation Skills

Types of Conferences & Meetings

- *Academic conferences*: research sharing, panel discussions.
- *Corporate meetings*: strategy sessions, team briefings.
- *Workshops and seminars*: interactive training.
- *Symposia and forums*: debate and policy dialogue.
- Etc.

Essential Soft Skills in Presentations

- Body language.
- Voice projection.
- Understanding the audience.
- Overcoming nervousness.

Essential Soft Skills in Presentations - Body Language

- Body language as non-verbal communication.
- *Posture and Gestures*
  - ❖ Posture: upright, open stance, no slouching.
  - ❖ Gestures: purposeful hand movement, avoid fidgeting.
  - ❖ Avoid crossing arms ➔ signals defensiveness.
- *Facial Expressions*
  - ❖ Smile naturally ➔ builds rapport.
  - ❖ Eye contact: 60–70% of the time.

Essential Soft Skills in Presentations - Body Language (Cont.)

- *Confidence*
  - *Strategies*
    - Preparation = confidence booster.
    - Deep breathing and visualization.
    - Reframe anxiety as positive energy.
    - Practice under real conditions.
  - *Mindset*
    - Focus on message, not self.
  - *Handling mistakes*
    - Pause, recover gracefully.

Essential Soft Skills in Presentations - Voice Projection

- Voice must reach the last row clearly.
- Be sufficiently loud but natural.
- Avoid unnecessary pauses or monotony.
- Tone and pace help sustain audience engagement.

Essential Soft Skills in Presentations - Understanding the Audience

- Audience may be from diverse backgrounds.
- Avoid insensitive or politically charged remarks.
- Knowing the audience helps in structuring material.
- Establish empathy and inclusiveness.

Essential Soft Skills in Presentations - Overcoming Nervousness

- Nervousness is natural and can enhance performance.
- Strategies
  - ❖ Relax with a comfortable posture.
  - ❖ Take deep breaths, focus.
  - ❖ Maintain eye contact with friendly faces.
  - ❖ Remember: the audience is interested in listening.

Structure of a Presentation

- Organize the presentation according to its purpose and goals, following the report format outlined in Chapter 2.
- An example of a standard order is as follows.
  - ❖ Introduction (3 min).
  - ❖ Main body (10 min).
  - ❖ Conclusion (2 min).
  - ❖ Q&A (5 min).

  Note: Presentation time depends on the conference requirements.
- Helps maintain clarity and flow.

Techniques for Effective Presentations

- Choose an appropriate medium.
- Familiarize yourself with technology.
- Grab attention with a strong opener.
- Speak with confidence.
- Keep the presentation concise.
- Use repetition strategically.
- Summarize at the end.

Tools & Visual Aids for Effective Presentations

- **Traditional Tools**
  - ❖ Handouts for reference.
  - ❖ Workshop activities.
  - ❖ PowerPoint & visual aids.
  - ❖ Etc.
- **Modern Tools**
  - ❖ Prezi, Canva ➔ creative design.
  - ❖ Miro, MURAL ➔online collaboration.
  - ❖ Mentimeter, Slido ➔ live polls & quizzes.
  - ❖ AI tools (Tome, Beautiful.ai) ➔ smart slides creation.
  - ❖ Etc.

Enhancing Presentation Delivery

- *Voice:* clarity, tone, modulation.
- *Timing:* pacing, pausing, emphasizing key points.
- *Engagement:* rhetorical questions, storytelling, visuals.
- Etc.

Professional Etiquette

- Dress appropriately for the event.
- Address audience formally (titles, greetings).
- Respect allotted time.
- Show gratitude (organizers, audience).
- Etc.

Practice 3

Task 1: "Deliver a 2-min conference-style self-introduction"

and

Task 2: "Improvised short speech for 10 minutes (your topic)"

Your tasks:

- 5 - 10 members per group.
- Discuss for 15 minutes.
- Choose 2 members and assign roles to each member; Conduct your practice on the stage.
- The classmates vote on clarity, timing, and engagement for Task 1. Similarly, you assess body language and confidence for Task 2.

Group Elocution

- Impromptu Speaking.
- Feedback and Improvement.
- Graded Rehearsal.

Group Elocution – What is Impromptu Speaking?

- Speaking without preparation or prior notice.
- Requires clarity, quick thinking, and adaptability.
- Common in
  - ❖ Q&A sessions.
  - ❖ Job interviews.
  - ❖ Academic discussions.
  - ❖ Networking events.

Group Elocution – Structure for Impromptu Speaking

- The ***PREP*** Method
  - *Point* – State your main idea.
  - *Reason* – Explain why it matters.
  - *Example* – Give evidence or illustration.
  - *Point* – Conclude and restate your idea.

Group Elocution – Tips for Impromptu Speaking

- Take *a short pause* before speaking.
- Organize ideas in *2–3 key points*.
- Use *transition phrases* (e.g., “Firstly, … Secondly, … Finally …”).
- Avoid filler words (*uh, um, you know*).
- Maintain *eye contact and steady pace*.

Group Elocution – Feedback and Improvement

- Feedback should focus on
  - ❖ Content clarity.
  - ❖ Delivery style (voice, tone, gestures).
  - ❖ Audience engagement.
  - ❖ Confidence level.
- Use the “Feedback Sandwich” method:
  - ❖ Start with positive observation.
  - ❖ Give constructive advice.
  - ❖ End with encouragement.

Group Elocution – Overcoming Stage Fright

- Preparation reduces fear.
- Breathe deeply before speaking.
- Focus on the message, not yourself.
- Use positive self-talk (“I am ready. I can do this.”).
- Etc.

Practice 4

“Each student picks a random topic (e.g., “The importance of failure,” “Social media in learning,” “Should AI replace teachers?”,…)”

- Presentation duration: 5 minutes / member.

Your tasks:

- ❖5 - 10 members per group.
- ❖Discuss for 15 minutes.
- ❖Choose 2 members; Conduct your practice on the stage.
- ❖The classmates vote on clarity, structure, confidence, and time management.

In conclusion

- Types of Conferences & Meetings.
- Enhancing Presentation Delivery.
- Professional Etiquette.
- Body Language.
- Group Elocution Practice.

Practice

Practice 1

- ***Role-Plays***
  - ❖ Pair practice: One student acts as a customer, the other as Front Office staff.
  - ❖ Telephone call simulation using audio prompts.

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Practice 2

Mock Interview

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- After the interview, the observer must objectively evaluate and document both strengths and areas for improvement during the interview.

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4. Leader Skills

Benefits of Leadership Communication

- *Inspiring action*
  - ❖ Effective communication empowers leaders to motivate teams and drive decisions.
- *Building confidence*
  - ❖ Clear messaging reinforces confidence when sharing organizational vision.
- *Conveying insights*
  - ❖ Leaders transmit understanding and strategic recommendations effectively.

Foundation Principles for Leader Messaging

- *Prioritise*
  - ❖ Plan and sequence messages clearly (aim, deadline, resources).
- *Repeat your communication*
  - ❖ Reinforce understanding by delivering key messages multiple times across formats.
- *Be visible within the organisation*
  - ❖ Engage face-to-face to foster approachability, trust, and alignment.

Empathy and Clarity

- *Empathise*
  - ❖ Demonstrate understanding by acknowledging emotions and responding considerately.
- *Explain complex strategy simply*
  - ❖ Simplify key ideas, avoid jargon, ensure clarity and direction.

Two-Way Communication & Feedback

- *Listen actively*
  - ❖ Engage fully with verbal and nonverbal cues; ask open-ended, clarifying questions.
- *Motivate*
  - ❖ Encourage participation and ownership through inclusive dialogue.
- *Openness*
  - ❖ Value diverse opinions; listen beyond your echo chamber to build trust.

Trust, Authenticity & Practice

- *Feedback*
  - ❖ Invite staff insight (even anonymously) to improve your communication.
- *Align words with actions*
  - ❖ Follow through on promises to maintain credibility and trust.
- *Speak to individuals*
  - ❖ Personalise communication style to audience segments.

Trust, Authenticity & Practice (Cont.)

- *Be genuine and honest*
  - ❖ Authenticity fosters respect and sustainable leadership.
- *Lead by example*
  - ❖ Model behaviors you expect to see in others.
- *Practice communication skills*
  - ❖ Regular rehearsal (e.g., coaching, peer role-play) creates mastery.

In conclusion

- Benefits of Leadership Communication.
- Foundation Principles for Leader Messaging.
- Empathy and Clarity.
- Two-Way Communication & Feedback.

5. Oral Presentation I & II

Oral Presentation I

Warm-up

- ***Icebreaker activity***
  - "*Introduce yourself with one interesting fact about your academic or professional experience.*"
  - Focus on
    - Eye contact.
    - Volume and clarity.
    - Engaging delivery.
    - Etc.

Keys to Effective Presentation

- *Hook and Introduction*
  - ❖ Grab audience attention (e.g., a question, fact, or story).
- *Logical Flow of Ideas*
  - ❖ Structured arguments with smooth transitions.
- *Transition Phrases*
  - ❖ "Firstly…," "On the other hand…," "In conclusion…"
- *Conclusion and Call to Action*
  - ❖ Summarize + inspire reflection or action.

Individual Presentation

Practice 1

- **Task:**
  - ❖ Present 15 minutes on "*The biggest challenge in university learning and how to overcome it.*"

Your tasks:

- ❖5 - 10 members per group.
- ❖Discuss for 15 minutes.
- ❖Choose 2 members for practice on the stage in order.
- ❖The classmates evaluate and send feedback based on the following criteria.
  - ➢Structure (Intro–Body–Conclusion).
  - ➢Pronunciation & Fluency.
  - ➢Body Language (gestures, posture, eye contact, etc.).

Pair Work

Practice 2

- **Task:**
  - ❖ In pairs, present 15 minutes on "*The impact of technology on modern education.*"

Your tasks:

- ❖5 - 10 members per group.
- ❖Discuss for 15 minutes.
- ❖Choose 2 members and assign roles for practice on the stage.
- ❖The classmates evaluate and send feedback based on the following criteria.
  - ➢Equal speaking time.
  - ➢Smooth transitions between speakers.
  - ➢Maintaining audience engagement.

Oral Presentation II

Warm-up

- ***Quick activity***
  - ❖ "*Summary a current news headline in 2 minutes.*"
  - ❖ Focus on
    - ➢ Concise delivery.
    - ➢ Relevance to audience.
    - ➢ Clarity of message.
    - ➢ Etc.

Key Techniques

- Storytelling in academic presentations
  - ❖ Engage attention, create emotional connection.
- Using data/evidence persuasively:
  - ❖ Integrate statistics, charts, and case studies.
- Handling audience questions
  - ❖ Listen actively, clarify, and respond with confidence.

Group Presentation

Practice 3

- **Task:**
  - ❖ Present 15 minutes on "*The role of Artificial Intelligence in business and society.*"

Your tasks:

- ❖5 - 10 members per group.
- ❖Discuss for 15 minutes and use PowerPoint (max 5 slides).
- ❖Include at least 1 chart or visual aid.
- ❖Choose 3-4 members and assign roles for practice on the stage.
- ❖The classmates evaluate and send feedback based on the following criteria.
  - ➢Structure and clarity.
  - ➢Effective use of visuals.
  - ➢Balance among group members.

Q&A Simulation

Practice 4

- **Task:**
  - ❖ After each group presentation, peers ask 3 questions.

Your tasks:

❖5 - 10 members per group.

❖The group should listen attentively and ask relevant questions regarding the presenter's topic. Afterwards, you should provide feedback based on the presenter's responses.

Presenters should practice:

❖Listening carefully.

❖Responding concisely & confidently.

❖Referring back to evidence or slides.

Practice

Individual Presentation

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Q&A Simulation

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THANK YOU
FOR YOUR ATTENTION

Q&A